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Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
Washington, DC 20515

January 5, 2012

Honorable Ray H. LaHood
Secretary
U. S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave., SE
Washington, DC 20590-0001

Dear Secretary LaHood,

I am writing this letter in support of the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) in its application for a Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant through the U.S. Department of Transportation.

Funding from this grant, should the ORTC receive it, would be used to complete design, engineering, and construction specification work on the first phase of the South Shore Trail. As part of the forty-one mile Ohio River Trail, this section of the trail extends existing trail systems along the Ohio River and into the city of Coraopolis, PA, and provides a connection to the communities of Sewickley, Edgeworth, Leetsdale, and Ambridge, PA. The valuable and widely supported Ohio River Trail will establish a tri-state corridor of natural and cultural resources between Ohio, Pennsylvania, and West Virginia that provides recreational opportunities, attracts investment, and creates safe transportation networks.

I am pleased to lend my strong support to the Ohio River Trail Council's application and I hope your office will give its request full consideration. If you have any questions regarding this matter please contact my District Director, Michelle Dorothy, at michelle.dorothy@mail.house.gov or 724-378-0928. Thank you for your time and attention to this important issue.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Jason Altmire".

Jason Altmire
Member of Congress

JA: cgm

Cc: Vincent Troia, Ohio River Trail Council CEO